fixed options to the user, before moving on to the special nature of the check box and radio input types.

6.3 The select tag helper

In our application, each property must be located in a particular city, so when the user adds a new property, they should be able to specify the city in which the property is located. You could provide a text input for this, but the problem with allowing users to enter whatever they want is that you are likely to get typos and variations. For example, do they enter *New York* or *New York City*? The solution provides a predetermined set of options the user can select from. The most economical and usable way to do this from a UI perspective is to present the options in an HTML select element for a list that could grow quite a bit.

The select tag helper targets the HTML select element. It has two custom attributes: the now-familiar `for` attribute, which is used to bind a `PageModel` property representing the selected value to the select element, and an `items` attribute, by which you assign the options. Options are populated from a collection of `SelectListItem` objects, a `SelectList` object, or an enumeration. Options can also be set individually via the option tag helper.

6.3.1 Creating options

The HTML option element represents a single option in a select element. At the very least, it consists of text displayed in the browser. The simplest way to create options for a select tag helper is to pass a collection of some kind, like the array of cities you worked with in the last chapter, to the constructor